

CHALLENGE #23: Unminify Write-up.

Unminify

Easy

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2024

obfuscation

browser_webshell_solvable

minification

AUTHOR: JEFFERY JOHN

Description

I don't like scrolling down to read the code of my website, so I've squished it. As a bonus, my pages load faster!

Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is: NOT_RUNNING

Launch Instance

75,063 users solved

1

2

3

Minification reduces the size of code, but does not change its functionality.

1

2

3

Try CTRL+U / ⌘+U in your browser to view the page source. You can also add 'view-source:' before the URL, or try `curl <URL>` in your shell.

1

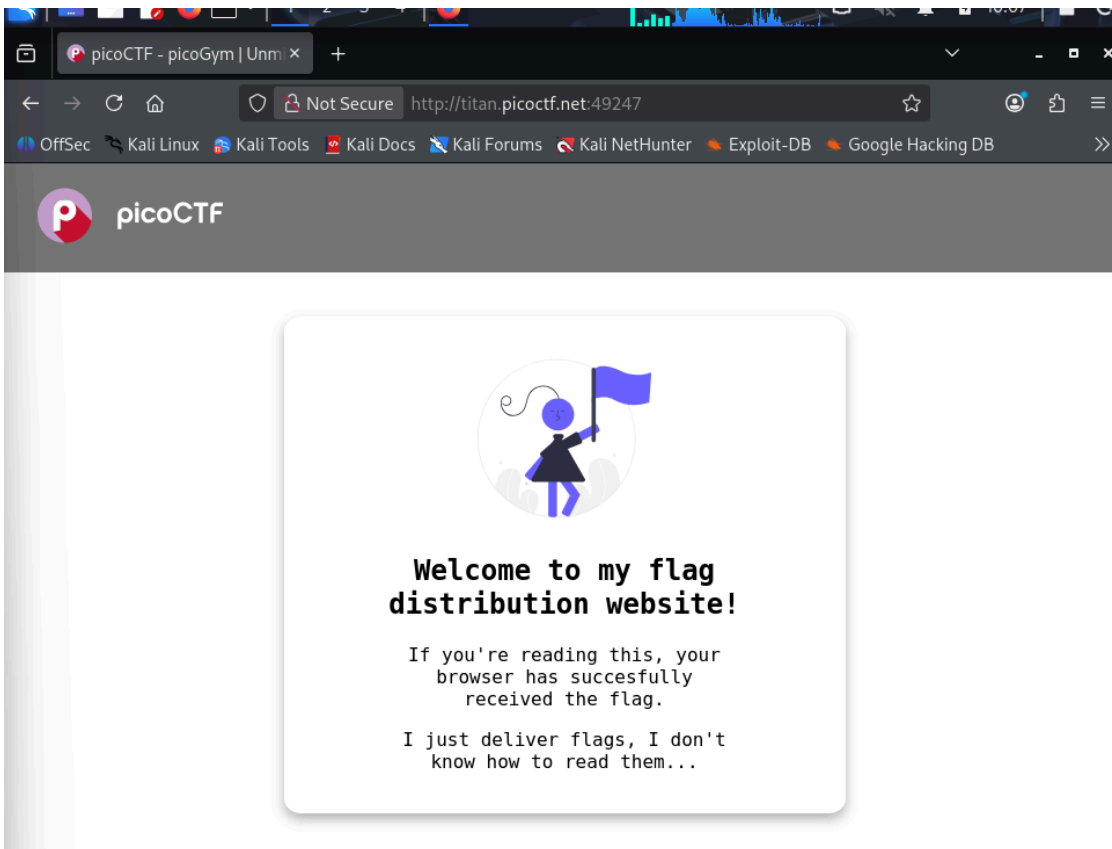
2

3

What tools do developers use when working on a website? Many text editors and browsers include formatting.

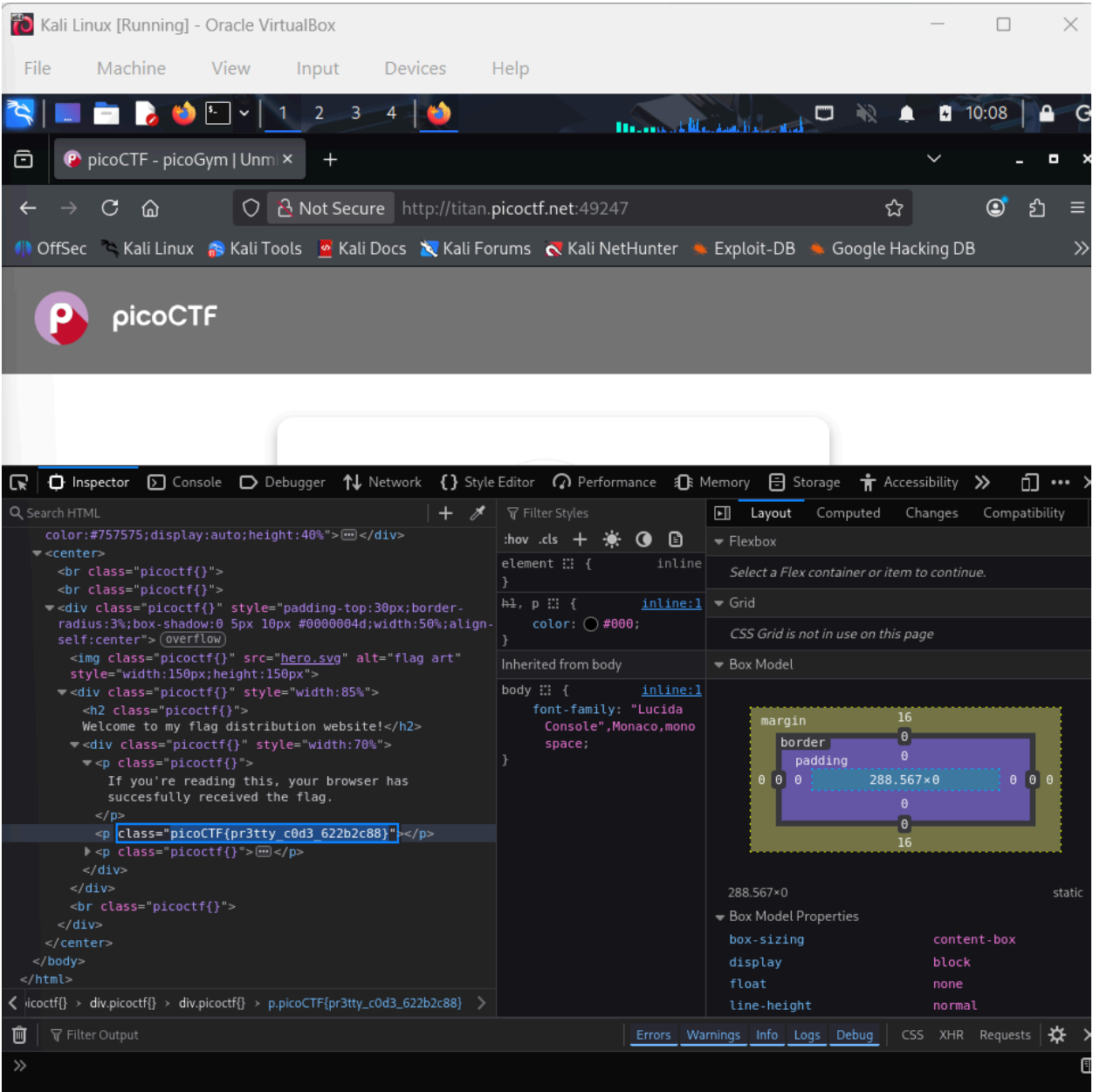
Solving Process:

The description mentioned that the developer “squished” the code to avoid scrolling, which suggested that the flag might be hidden within the HTML structure of the webpage.



To investigate further, the web inspector was opened. Inside the HTML panel, a `div` element with the class `picoCTF` was observed. Expanding this element revealed several nested elements that contained the visible text on the webpage, such as the header “**Welcome to my flag distribution website.**” and a paragraph indicating that the browser had successfully received the flag.

While continuing to expand the HTML structure, another paragraph element (`<p>`) was discovered. Upon inspecting the website's HTML, a second `<p>` element was found positioned immediately after the one stating, "If you're reading this, your browser has successfully received the flag." This specific element contained a class attribute that explicitly detailed the flag.



Unminify

Easy

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2024

obfuscation

browser_webshell_solvable

minification

AUTHOR: JEFFERY JOHN

Description

I don't like scrolling down to read the code of my website, so I've squished it. As a bonus, my pages load faster!

Browse [here](#), and find the flag!

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is: **RUNNING**

Instance Time Remaining: **29:20**

Restart Instance

75,063 users solved

Hints ?

123

85% Liked

🚩 picoCTF{pr3tty_c0d3_622b2c88}

Submit Flag

Hurray! You solved this challenge.

Reflection:

This challenge demonstrated how hidden information can be stored within HTML elements and CSS classes that are not immediately visible on the webpage. By carefully inspecting the webpage structure using developer tools, it was possible to uncover hidden data embedded within the code. The activity highlighted the importance of analyzing both HTML and CSS when investigating web-based security challenges.